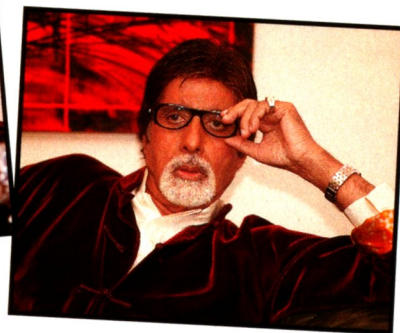




Amitabh BACHCHAN Shoots From The Lip



exist because of it."

character. When you go cut, you realise you're family. We had an incredible rapport even before we became family, so it's not that suddenly there was this bonhomie.

Amitabh Bachchan (AB). We've done it before in *Bunty Aur Babli*. We're all actors. Because we were at Ramoji Film City where we had to live and work on the premises, we had dinner together daily and usually drove to work together, in one car if possible. There was hardly anything else to do.

Q. How was your experience at Cannes this year?

AB. All of us had been shooting in different cities. Abhishek was in Miami, I was in Nashik and then in Shimla. Aishwarya had been in Jaipur. We had not come together for a very long time. She goes every year as the brand ambassador of L'Oreal, which is one of the sponsors for the Cannes film festival. It's mandatory for her to be there, and to represent L'Oreal the way it wants to be represented—so all this talk of this dress not being good or she not wearing a sari, it's not in her control. We just went along because we wanted

to be together. It was like going to any of her premieres.

Q. Like Aishwarya would go with you to the temples?

AB. No, everybody goes to temples. There's no question of who is coming or who is not coming.

Q. You've read about yourself being a manglik...

Abhishek to Aishwarya. I don't think she's a manglik.

Q. And about being dragged from temple to temple, Aishwarya. Does it bother you?

AB. Why do you use that word dragged?

Q. Because that is the word often used.

AB. Well, that's wrong terminology.

Aishwarya. It's ridiculous that a word like this is attributed. It's designed to direct the readers' perspective. It's tired and it's old. So much time has passed. This talk started at least four-five months before our marriage. It dragged on for a couple of months after the wedding until Pa decided to speak. He made himself available to the media. He actually went to media houses. He spoke extensively and mailed interviews himself so there would be no Chinese whispers. If even after that certain individuals choose to turn a deaf ear and persist in this train of thought, all we can do now is hope the reader is discerning enough. The media has decided to keep the myth going and not validate the facts enough. What

more can be done? Pa has spoken and now he writes his blog. So go out there and get the truth, if you're interested.

Q. Is that one of the reasons you started writing the blog, Mr Bachchan?

AB. No, I just came to know about it a month ago. It's a beautiful vehicle to communicate with your fans.

Q. Abhishek, you've been attacked for your two movies last year—Jhoom Barabar Jhoom and Laga Chunari Main Daag—as well as for your weight gain. Is that hurtful?

AB Jr. No. You get used to it. What's disappointing is when they do it without looking for the reason. They must realise that we as actors are meant to present ourselves as a block of clay and allow the director to do what he wants. I put on weight for *Guru*, I lost it then for *Jhoom Barabar Jhoom*, for which I also grew my hair. After which I started working on *Sarkar Raj*. Ramu (Ram Gopal Varma, the director) and I decided we wanted my character to look healthy, more prosperous, settled, unlike *Sarkar*, where he had just returned